



Partnerships and Engagement

Harnessing the Power of Collaboration!



OKIPSE Alliance additional partners:



Capacity Building - Alliance

Educate

Advocate

Assist

Collaborate



Support Inclusive Post Secondary Education Programs and the students they serve

Connected Community

ENGAGEMENT

STARTED with Key Leaders:

DRS/VR

DHS/DDS

OSRHE

OSDE

Sooner SUCCESS



IPSE Programs

Department of Rehabilitation Services

Vocational Rehabilitation = DRS/VR

Non-Profit Organizations = Service

Board of Regents for Higher Education = OSRHE

Foundations

Workforce Innovation Board = WIB

Parent Support Groups = Autism/Down Syndrome

Family Members

Institutions of Higher Education (Career Tech +)

Policy Makers

Department of Human Services

Developmental Disability Services = DHS/DDS

State Department of Education - OSDE

National Interest

Business Leaders

Students!

Oklahoma

Northeastern State University - RiverHawks Scholar Program

- Tahlequah Campus
- 4-year inclusive certificate program for students with IDD
- CTP Designated

Oklahoma State University – Opportunity Orange Scholars

- Stillwater Campus
- 2-Year inclusive certificate program with a future advanced opportunity for students with IDD
- CTP Designated

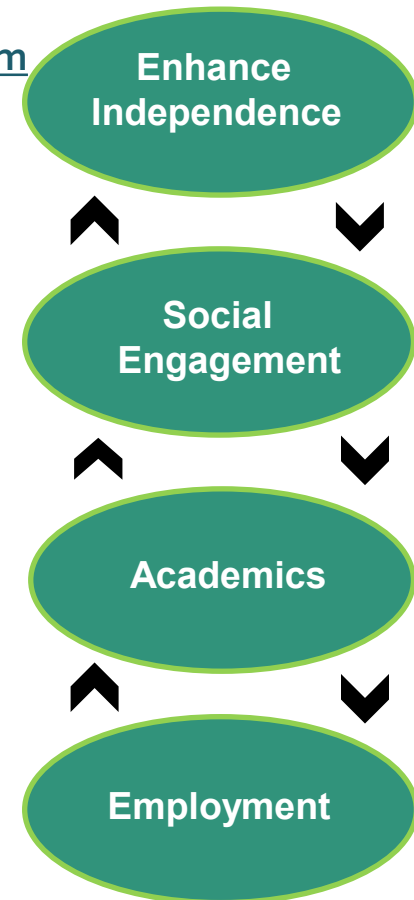
University of Oklahoma – Sooner Works

- Norman Campus
- 4-year inclusive certificate program for students with IDD
- CTP Designated

University of Science and Arts of Oklahoma – Neill-Wint Center for Neurodiversity

- Chickasha
- 4-year degree program provides supports for students with autism

CTP = Comprehensive Transition Program



Partnerships = Engagement

WHO?	WHAT?	WHY IT MATTERS?
Vocational Rehabilitation (VR)	Contract with each program providing up to \$3,000 per semester dependent upon family income. Also pays for up to 15 internship hours per week (VR Clients)	-Allows students to have paid internships -Facilitates learning about financial responsibility -Employment!
Workforce Investment Board (WIB) working with Pre-ETS (Pre-employment Transition Services) Address 5 Required WIOA Categories - Job Exploration Counseling - Work-Based Learning - Post-Secondary Counseling - Workplace Readiness - Self-Advocacy	IPSE NEXT! Unique Partnership with COWIB providing traveling Work Skills Trainers for IPSE students working off campus while in the IPSE program as well as after graduation. Works with employers, IPSE Staff and Students to assist with meaningful employment	-Support for students in the Community -“Off Ramp” when students complete college to help with employment -Assists IPSE staff -Assists employers with successful hires

Partnerships = Engagement

WHO?

Developmental Disability Services (DDS)

Oklahoma City Community Foundation (OCCF)



WHAT?

Current “Ask” is for students on the Medicaid Waiver to be able to use Self Directed Goods and Services (SDGS) dollars towards IPSE program costs
In Process: a working meeting to formulate a pilot acceptable to all parties

Revise scholarship language to include students in CTP designated programs and expand their policy to include IPSE students in new endeavors. With employer connections, provide host site for employer education as well as scholarship/grant support

WHY IT MATTERS?

- Families need help paying for IPSE
- IPSE should be a choice of where SDGS dollars can go if IPSE is a good fit for the student
- Strengthens partnership with DRS/VR

- Education of a key state foundation
- Scholarships for students
- Grants for IPSE programs
- Expands messaging to groups typically not reached



- 7 Divisions
- Over 1,000 employees
- 25 Statewide Programs
- School for the Blind
- School for the Deaf

Focus: Personal, Social and Work Adjustment Skills in Workplace Learning

Building Employment Skills Today
**BEST
STEP**
Summer Transition Employment Program

Program highlights

- TENTATIVE DATES: JUNE 5 TO JULY 31
- APPLICATION AND INTERVIEW REQUIRED
- ONE WEEK OF EMPLOYMENT TRAINING
- UP TO 4 1/2 DAYS OF PART-TIME WORK, AND 1/2 DAY OF SKILL DEVELOPMENT AND DEBRIEFING WEEKLY

Scan the QR Code to apply for the Best Step program.



Gain summer work experience and improve your job readiness!

Are you at least 16 years old with a documented disability, a client of DRS, potentially eligible for services due to your disability, and returning to high school in August 2023?

Are you interested in gaining work skills this summer while learning from instructors and working in your community?

The Oklahoma Department of Rehabilitation Services (DRS) and OU Pre-Employment Transition Services (Pre-ETS) invites its Transition clients to participate in the BEST STEP Summer Programs.

For more information or to request a PDF (printable & fillable) application, please contact:
Nina Sansom Grieco
405-951-3488 or 405-212-7789
or by email at nsansom@okdrs.gov.

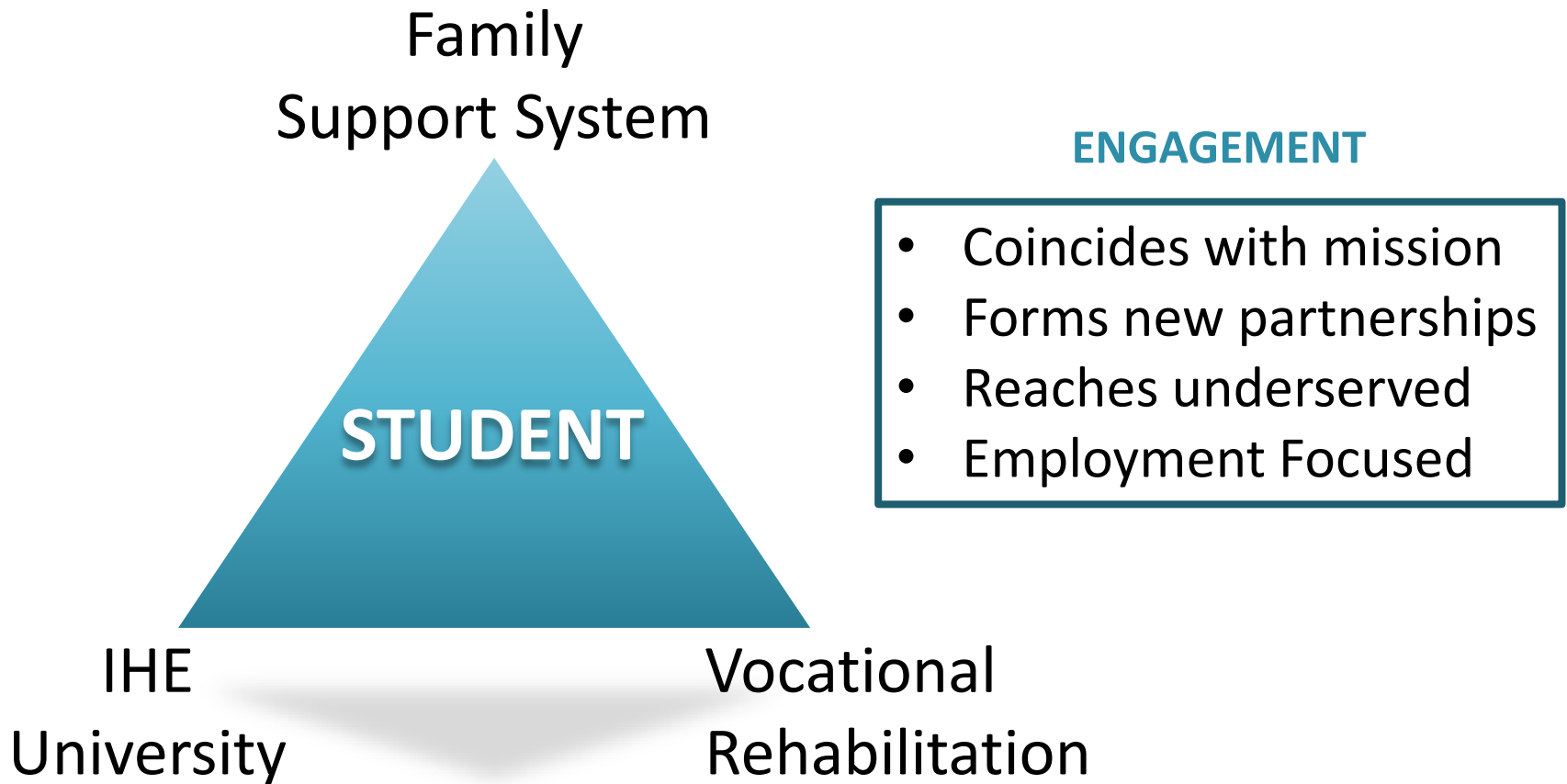


VR Clients:
Students
with IPSE
as a goal in
their IPE

IPSE!

BEST = Building Employment Skills for Today
STEP = Summer Transition Employment Program

DRS expands opportunities for employment and economic self-sufficiency by helping Oklahomans with disabilities bridge barriers to success at work.



DRS/VR – First Partner with IPSE

PROCESS:

Early Discussions – Early Relationships/Education

DATA! Statistics showing employment success

Information/Discussion with other states: Ex: Pennsylvania

Team Discussion – Key leaders for working session

Budget and Logistics – Discovery Period

Pilot Development – Develop Pilot Contract with First Program



Pilot

Up to \$3,000 per semester

- Must be VR Client
- Based on Family Financial Guidelines
- All paperwork must be completed before approval
- Counselors must be educated and involved prior to student's acceptance into IPSE program
- IPSE must be included in IPE

Internships

- Up to 15 hours per week
- Minimum Wage
- 10 weeks per semester
- DRS pays IHE/Program; Program pays student
- Counselors check on student's progress and employment in area of interest

Partnerships, Challenges, Wins

Partnerships

- WorkForce Boards
- IPSE Programs
- DHS/DDS Potential

**Avoid Duplicating
Services**

Challenges

- Counselor Education
- Staffing
- IHE Differences

**New Processes
Infographics
Video Training**

Wins!

- 86% Employment
- Competitive Employment
- Meets DRS Goals

**Expansion Potential
Increase Support?**

The Reason



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Connect



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